

```
$ swapon /digit-swap
```

This will make the file **digit-swap** in the root directory as an active swap space. The swap files are hot pluggable, which means you don't need to restart the system.

Now doing a swapon everytime your computer starts is a very cumbersome method, so we will create an entry into the **/etc/fstab** file so that our swap is mounted automatically on boot.

So the entries as follow in your **/etc/fstab**

/dev/sda4	none	swap	SW	0	0
/swapfile	none	swap	SW	0	0

indicate a whole partition **/dev/sda4** and a file **digit-swap** being used as swap. A quick tip is that partition names starting with **sda** are typically SATA disk partitions and **hda** are your older PATA disk partitions.

To monitor your current ram usage and swap usage, you can always issue the command as follows:

```
$ free
```

this will produce the output of following format:

	total	used	free	shared
buffers	cached			
Mem:	3989104	3564764	424340	0
229092	592048			
-/+ buffers/cache:		2743624	1245480	
Swap:	999416	33276	966140	



Remember that since swap is used only when the operating system is running, if you have multiple installations of various variants of linux on your system, you can use the same swap partition for all of them, rather it will be a recommended practice.

It's a good idea to have at least some swap space, even if you think that you have enough ram to not need one. Linux uses swap space somewhat aggressively, so that as much physical memory as possible can be kept free. Linux will swap out memory pages that have not been used, even if the

A graphical way, using uber-cool conky to monitor your usage